The Constitution of India does not define Civil Contempt and/or Criminal Contempt. Hence Statement 3 is incorrect.
Parliament framed the Contempt of Courts Act, 1971, laying down procedure and punishment for contempt of court. Parliament has power to amend certain clauses of the Contempt of Courts Act, 1971 but according to latest Supreme Court ruling, no law can take away Court's power to punish for contempt. Hence statement 4 is correct.

12. With reference to India, consider the following statements:
1. Government law officers and legal firms are recognised as advocates, but corporate lawyers and patent attorneys are excluded from recognition as advocates.
2. Bar Councils have the power to lay down the rules relating to legal education and recognition of law colleges.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b): Corporate Lawyers, as well as patent attorneys, are too recognized as lawyers and there's no prohibition on their recognition as lawyers. Hence 1st statement is incorrect. The Bar Council of India visits and inspects Universities/Law colleges in the country as part of its statutory function of promoting legal education and laying down standards in consultation with the Universities in India and the State Bar Councils. The Bar Council of India is a statutory body established under section 4 of the Advocates Act 1961 that regulates the legal practice and legal education in India. Hence 2nd statement is correct.

13. Consider the following statements:
1. A bill amending the Constitution requires a prior recommendation of the President of India.
2. When a Constitution Amendment Bill is presented to the President of India, it is obligatory for the President of India to give his/her assent.
3. A Constitution Amendment Bill must be passed by both the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha by a special majority and there is no provision for joint sitting.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): The Bill amending the constitution does not require a prior recommendation from the President of India. Hence 1st statement is incorrect.
When a Constitution Amendment Bill is presented to the President of India, it is obligatory for the President of India to give his/her assent. The President cannot exercise his veto powers with reference to the Constitution amendment bill. Also according to Article 368, the Constitution can be amended only by a 2/3rd majority in both Houses. There is no provision for a joint sitting in case of a disagreement between both Houses. Hence 2nd and 3rd statements are correct.

14. Consider the following statement:
1. The Constitution of India classifies the ministers into four ranks viz. Cabinet Minister, Minister of State with Independent Charge, Minister of State and Deputy Minister.
2. The total number of ministers in the Union Government, including the Prime Minister, shall not exceed 15 percent of the total number of members in the Lok Sabha.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b): There is no classification in the Constitution of India for the Council of Ministers. Article 74 provides that there shall be a Council of Ministers with the Prime Minister at the head to aid and advise the President who shall, in the exercise of his functions, act in accordance with such advice. Hence 1st statement is incorrect.
According to the Constitution (91st Amendment) Act, 2003, that amended article 75, the total number of ministers, including the Prime Minister, in the cabinet of ministers shall not exceed 15% of the total strength of the Lok Sabha. Hence 2nd statement is correct.

15. Which of the following is/are the exclusive power(s) of Lok Sabha?
1. To ratify the declaration of Emergency
2. To pass a motion of no-confidence against the Council of Ministers.
3. To impeach the President of India

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only (c) 1 and 3 (d) 3 only

Ans. (b) : The Proclamation of Emergency must be approved by both the Houses of Parliament within one month from the date of its issue. If approved by both the Houses of Parliament, the emergency continues for six months, and can be extended to an indefinite period with an approval of the Parliament for every six months. As per Article 61, when a President is to be impeached for violation of the Constitution, the charges can be initiated by either House of Parliament. The impeachment resolution needs to be passed by a majority of two-thirds of the total membership in each house. Thus, it is not an exclusive power of the Lok Sabha.
However Article 75 (3) provides that the Council of Ministers shall be collectively responsible to the House of the People. So, only LokSabha can pass a no-confidence motion against the Council of Ministers. Hence it is an exclusive power of the Lok Sabha.

16. With reference to anti-defection law in India, consider the following statements:
1. The law specifies that a nominated legislator cannot join any political party within six months of being appointed to the House.
2. The law does not provide any time-frame within which the presiding officer has to decide a defection case.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b): A nominated member of a House shall be disqualified for being a member of the House if he joins any political party after the expiry of six months from the date on which he takes his seat after complying with the requirements of article 99 or, as the case may be. Hence 1st statement is incorrect. The law does not specify a time period for the Presiding Officer to decide on a disqualification plea under the Tenth Schedule. Hence 2nd statement is correct.

17. Consider the following statements:
1. Attorney General of India and Solicitor General of India are the only officers of the Government who are allowed to participate in the meetings of the Parliament of India.
2. According to the Constitution of India, the Attorney General of India submits his resignation when the Government which appointed him resigns.

Which of the statement given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d) : However, the Attorney General of India has the right to audience in all Courts in India as well as the right to take part in the proceedings of Parliament without the right to vote. The Solicitor General of India has no such privilege.
As per Article 76, the Attorney General shall hold office during the pleasure of the President. There is no mention in the Indian Constitution of the need for him to submit his resignation when the Government which appointed him resigns.
Hence both the statements are incorrect.

18. With the reference to the writs issued by the Courts in India, consider the following statements :
1. Mandamus will not lie against a private oragnisation unless it is entrusted with a public duty.
2. Mandamus will not lie against Company even though it may be a Government Company.
3. Any public minded person can be a petitioner to move the Court to obtain the writ of Quo Warranto.

Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : Mandamus is a command issued by the court to a public official asking him to perform his official duties that he has failed or refused to perform. It can also be issued against **any public body,** a corporation, an inferior court, a tribunal, or a government for the same purpose. It is usually not usable against a private entity unless it is entrusted with a public duty.
Quo Warranto is issued by the court to enquire into the legality of the claim of a person to a public office. Hence, it prevents illegal usurpation of public office by a person. Unlike the other writs, this can be sought by any interested person and not necessarily by the aggrieved person.
Hence only 1st and 3rd statements are correct. However the commission has considered option (d) is as correct answer.

19. With reference to Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission, consider the following statements:
1. Private and public hospitals must adopt it.
2. As it aims to achieve universal health coverage, every citizen of India should be part of it ultimately.
3. It has seamless portability across the country.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): Only the 3rd statement is correct. Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission will have a national footprint and will enable seamless portability across the country through a Health ID – Personal Health Identifier. The Mission (ABDM) has not made it mandatory for adoption by private and public hospitals. Its adoption so far would be voluntary. The aim of the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is to facilitate the ease of access to medical records and it is not been mandated to have every citizen as its part though the facility is available to every citizen on a consent basis.

20. With reference to Deputy Speaker of Lok Sabha, consider the following statements:
1. As per the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in Lok Sabha, the election of Deputy Speaker shall be held on such date as the Speaker may fix.
2. There is a mandatory provision that election of a candidate as Deputy Speaker of Lok Sabha shall be from either the principal opposition party or the ruling party.
3. The Deputy Speaker has the same power as of the Speaker when presiding over the sitting of the House and no appeal lies against his rulings.
4. The well established parliamentary practice regarding the appointment of Deputy Speaker is that the motion is moved by the Speaker and duly seconded by the Prime Minister.

Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 2 and 4 only

Ans. (a): As per Rule 8 of Procedure and Conduct of Business in Lok Sabha, the election of a Deputy Speaker shall be held on such date as the Speaker may fix, and the Secretary-General shall send to every member notice of this date. There is no mandatory provision that the election of a candidate, as Deputy Speaker of Lok Sabha, shall be from either the principal opposition party or the ruling party. It is only by convention that the position of Deputy Speaker is offered to the opposition party in India. In case of the absence of the Speaker, the Deputy Speaker presides over the sessions of the Lok Sabha and conducts the business in the house. The Deputy Speaker has the same power as the Speaker when presiding over the sitting of the House. The Deputy Speaker is also elected by the Lok Sabha from amongst its members right after the election of the Speaker has taken place. There is no provision and or established practice of moving the motion for his election by the speaker and it is seconded by the prime minister.

21. Among the following crops, which one is the most important anthropogenic source of both methane and nitrous oxide?
(a) Cotton (b) Rice (c) Sugarcane (d) Wheat

Ans. (b): Rice (Paddy) is considered as one of the most important sources of methane and nitrous oxide emissions, which have attracted considerable attention due to their contribution to global warming.

22. "System of Rice Intensification" of cultivation, in which alternate wetting and drying of rice fields is practised, results in:
1. Reduced seed requirement
2. Reduced methane production
3. Reduced electricity consumption

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d): The System of Rice Intensification involves cultivating rice with as much organic manure as possible. It includes a method called Alternate Wetting and Drying (AWD) which is a form of controlled or intermittent irrigation of the rice crops. It has the following benefits and impacts, compared to conventional methods of paddy cultivation:
It increases paddy yields usually by 20-50% and sometimes up to 100%,
It reduces required seeds for transplanting by 60-80%,
The electricity consumption will be less as it enables reduce use of chemical fertilizers and agrichemicals and reduced use of irrigation water by 25-50%,
By stopping flooding and relying mostly on organic fertilization, methane emissions are greatly reduced without offsetting increases in nitrous oxide.
Hence all the given statements are correct.